

This all-new version is totally rewritten to reflect what's going on in the world today. And unlike most personal finance books, this one focuses exclusively on what you need to know in your twenties and thirties—whether you earn \$20,000 or \$200,000, are single or married, financially flush or living paycheck to paycheck.

You'll learn how to eke out the most you can from your salary. You'll find out how to dig yourself out of debt. You'll discover where to stash your cash. You'll find the cheapest credit cards, car loans, and student loans. *Get a Financial Life* will help you understand and take advantage of automated savings plans, 401(k)s, and IRAs. You'll get no-nonsense, unbiased advice on how to select the best mutual funds. You'll pick up tax strategies that can save you hundreds of dollars a year. You'll learn how to avoid outrageous bank fees and how to determine which types of insurance you need—and which are a waste of money. You'll get well-vetted websites for every aspect of your financial life.

You'll get answers to specific questions that may have slowed you down in the past: What's my credit score and how can I improve it? Do I need a mortgage broker? How much should I contribute to my company's retirement plan? How do I figure out when it's time to stop renting and try to buy? Should I lease or buy a car? Where can I find help if I can't pay my bills? Also, if you're one of the millions of people in their twenties and thirties who are in the military (or recently finished serving), you'll get the details on education, home buying, and other special deals.

One more thing: If the thought of reading an entire book on personal finance leaves you cold, don't worry. Chapter 1 provides quick summaries of the most important steps. And throughout the book, "Financial Cramming" review sections highlight key concepts. So take the plunge, and read on. There's no better time for a personal finance overhaul. It's a lot easier than you might think—that is, if you take advantage of the one major benefit you still have on your side: *time*.